



BARING IT ALL

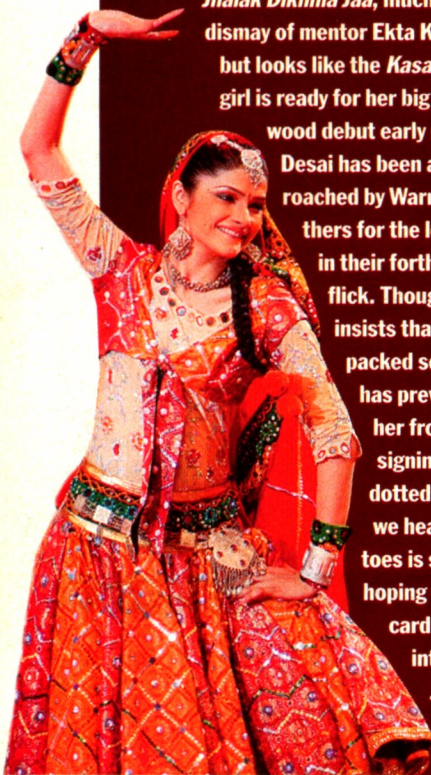
Even as rumour mills work overtime about actor **Sonali Kulkarni** shedding her girl-next-door tag along with her clothes in a dare-bare scene in Anand Rai's *Strangers*, she insists on setting the record straight. "It's a blink-and-you-miss scene and is not meant to be titillating. I give my soul to a character and if it requires me to be glamorous, I will not shy away from it. This role is very emotionally complex and delicate," she clarifies. And even while the semi-nude sequence might intrigue many, Kulkarni says she is just happy exploring cinema—"from Italian to regional and commercial". Who dares wins?

Ticket to Bollywood

Soap star **Prachi Desai**, 19, may be out of

Jhalak Dikhhla Jaa, much to the dismay of mentor Ekta Kapoor, but looks like the *Kasamh Se* girl is ready for her big Bollywood debut early next year.

Desai has been approached by Warner Brothers for the lead role in their forthcoming flick. Though she insists that her packed schedule has prevented her from signing on the dotted line yet, we hear twinkle toes is still hoping for a wild card entry into *Jhalak...* soon.



■ Compiled by **Kimi Dangor**



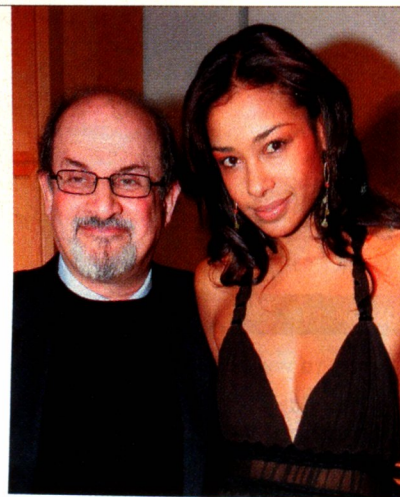
RAHUL IRANI

Radical Player

Believe it or not, he's going to be both swinging and singing at the 2011 cricket World Cup to be held in the Indian subcontinent. Details are still hush-hush but speed king **Brett Lee**, India's favourite Aussie cricketer, has been asked to produce and perform the official song for the 2011 ICC World Cup. Lee, nicknamed Binga, is quite a musician and also part of a Sydney band called Six & Out, which comprises cricketers. After a popular duet with Asha Bhosle, may be Binga's World Cup song will be in Hindi?

EX FILES

Even as **Sir Salman Rushdie's** ex-wife Padma Lakshmi lamented in print that he was still "the greatest love" of her life, the award-winning author seems to have moved on, and how. Rushdie, 60, was spotted at the Mahindra Indo-American Arts Council Film Festival in New York with a new woman friend, screenwriter Patrice Jorden, a dusky and willowy beauty much like his former wife. Looks like Rushdie has put his supermodel ex firmly in the past.



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